BEFORE
1990

A BILLION-DOLLAR TELESCOPE
NEEDED GLASSES



AFTER
1993

1.3 mm
one lens out of place

1/50
of a hair too flat

3 YEARS
of blur

WHY IT HAPPENED

1990

Hubble launches (about $1.5 billion). The first pictures come back blurry.

THE MIRROR

Too flat at the edge by about 1/50 of a human hair.

THE TOOL

One lens in the checking tool sat 1.3 mm out of place.

THE TRAP

Other tests disagreed. They trusted the tool.

1993

Astronauts fit corrective mirrors over five spacewalks. Sharp again.